

Domain Controller and Active Directory Lab

Part 4 – Establishing a dedicated Domain Administrator

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Technologies Used

- **Oracle VirtualBox**
- **Windows Server 2022**
- **Server Manager**
- **Active Directory Domain Services**

OBJECTIVE:

The objective of this lab is to establish a Domain Administrator account for the environment, rather than using the built in Administrator account. Implementing individual Administrator accounts follows enterprise security best practices by providing accountability, reducing dependence on default privileged accounts, supporting more secure management of the Active Directory environment.

Lab Setup:

This lab continues from Part 3, where the Windows Server 2022 system was promoted to the first Domain Controller within a new Active Directory forest. With Domain infrastructure now operational, this phase focuses on creating a dedicated Domain Administrator account that will be used for future administrative tasks, using a separate administrative account instead of the built-in Administrator account. This process better aligns with enterprise practices and establishes a more realistic Windows domain administration workflow.

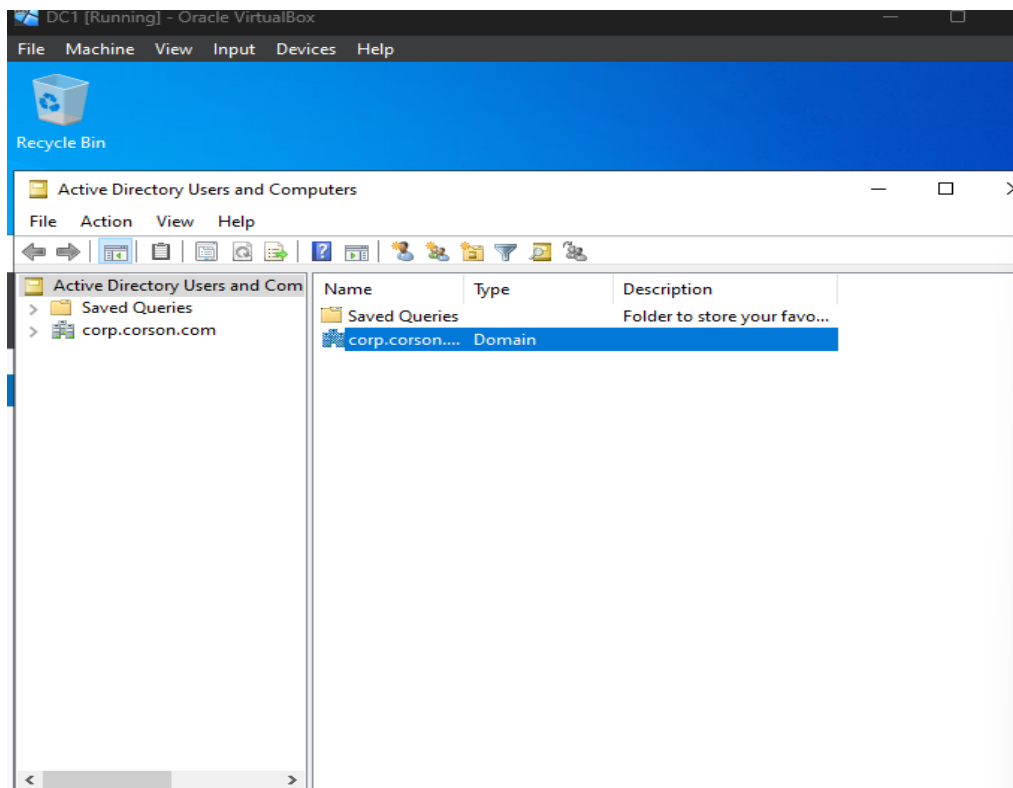


Figure 1. Selecting the Active Directory domain to create a new Organizational Unit (OU) named "Admins," which will contain dedicated administrative user accounts.

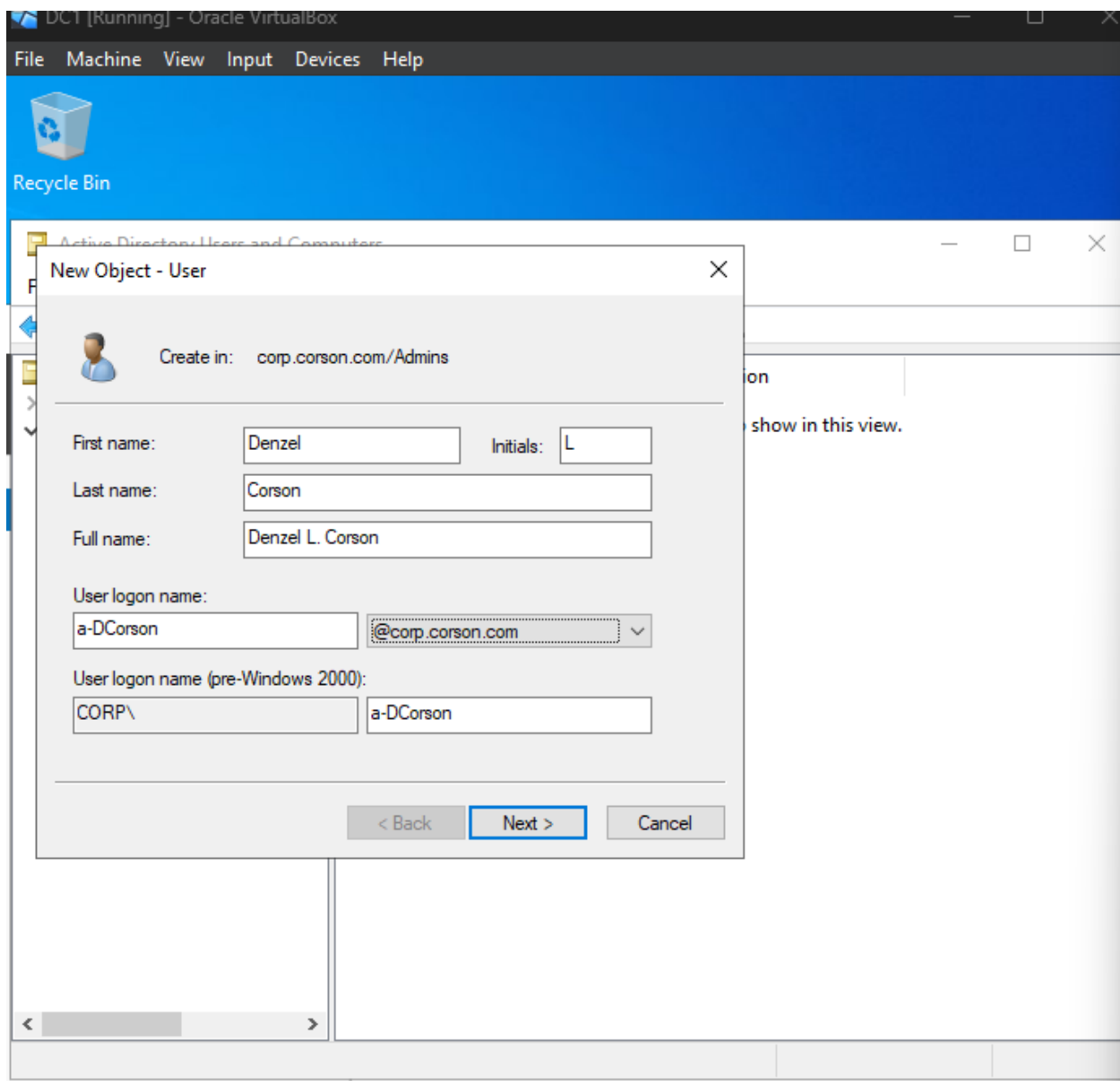


Figure 2. Creating a dedicated Domain Administrator account. In many enterprise environments, administrative accounts use a naming convention such as "a-" to distinguish privileged administrator accounts from standard user accounts.

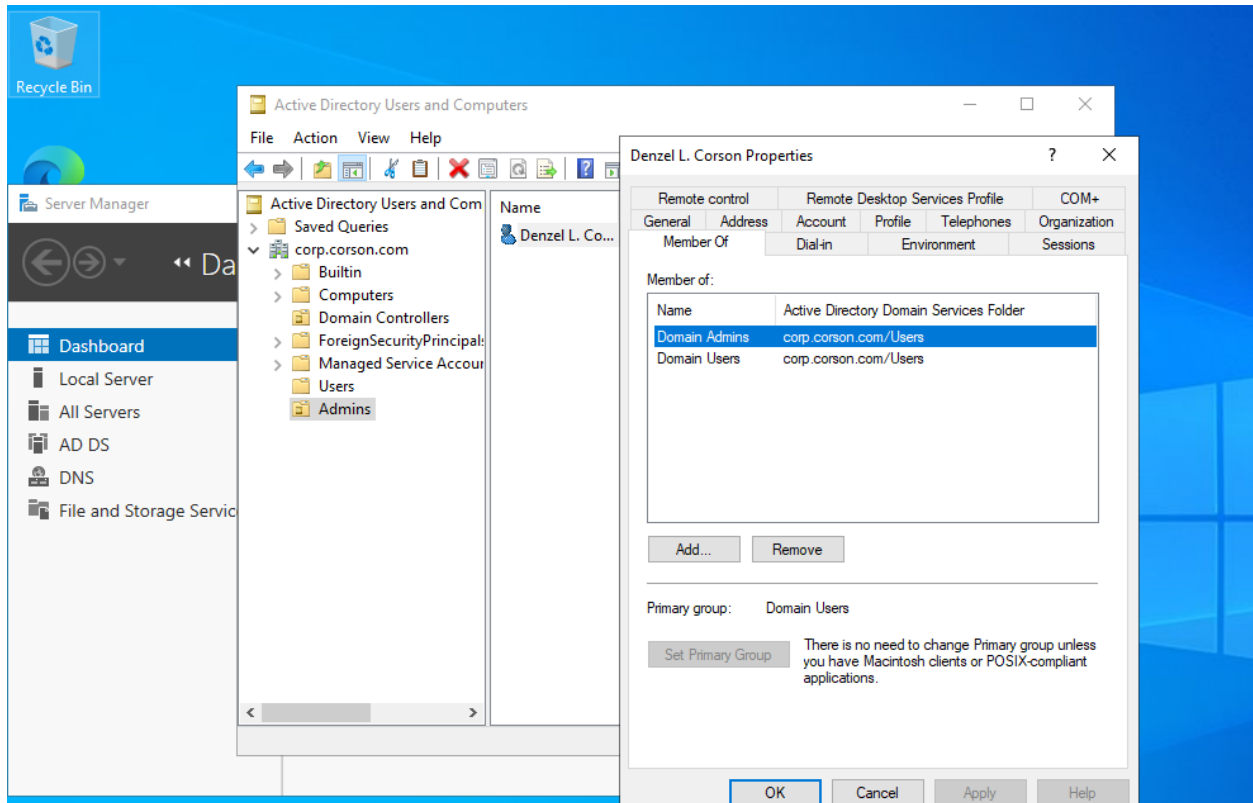


Figure 3. Adding the dedicated administrator account to the Domain Admins security group, granting the privileges required to administer the Active Directory environment..

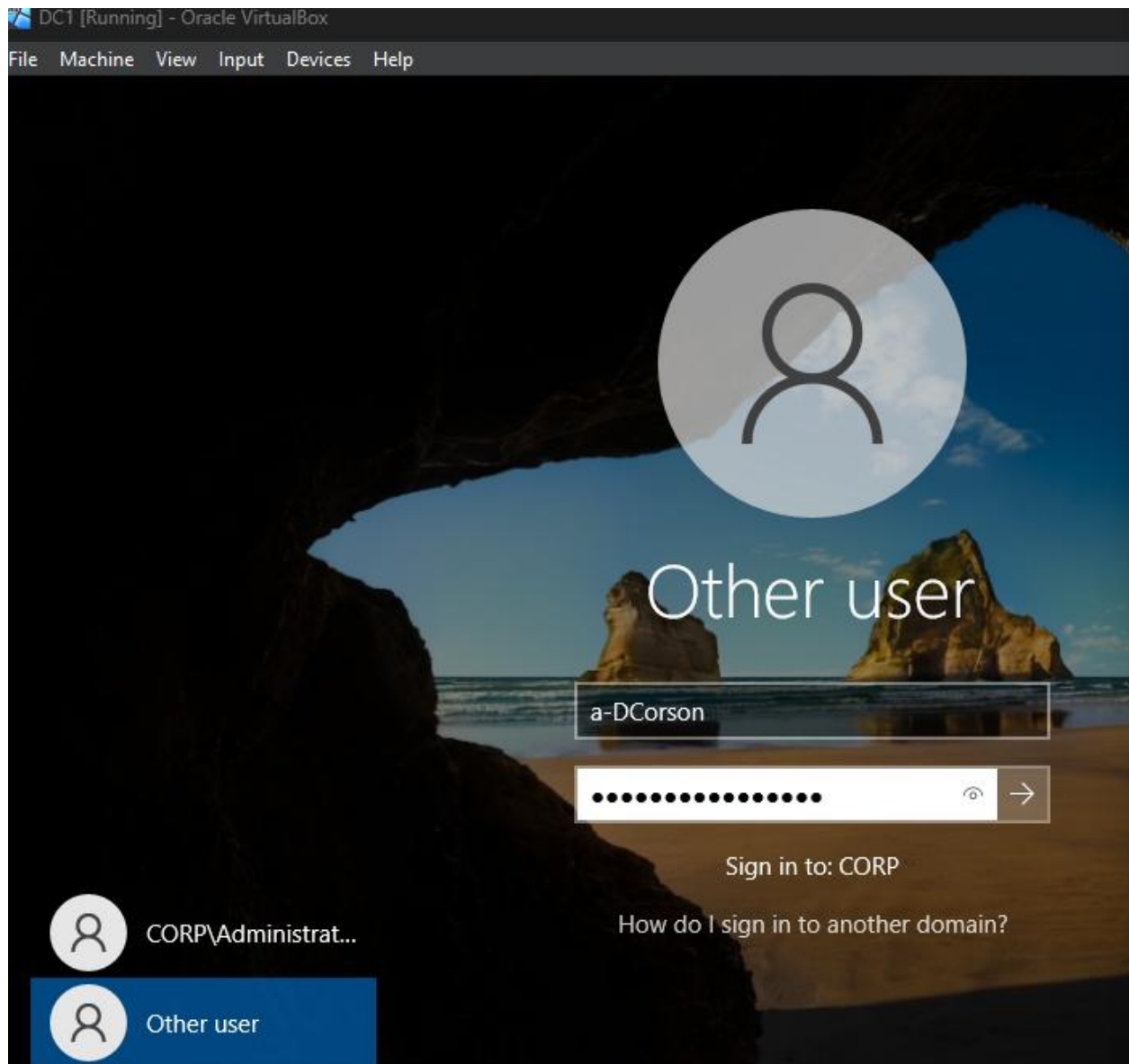


Figure 4. Verifying successful authentication by signing into the domain using the newly created dedicated Domain Administrator account (a-DCorson).

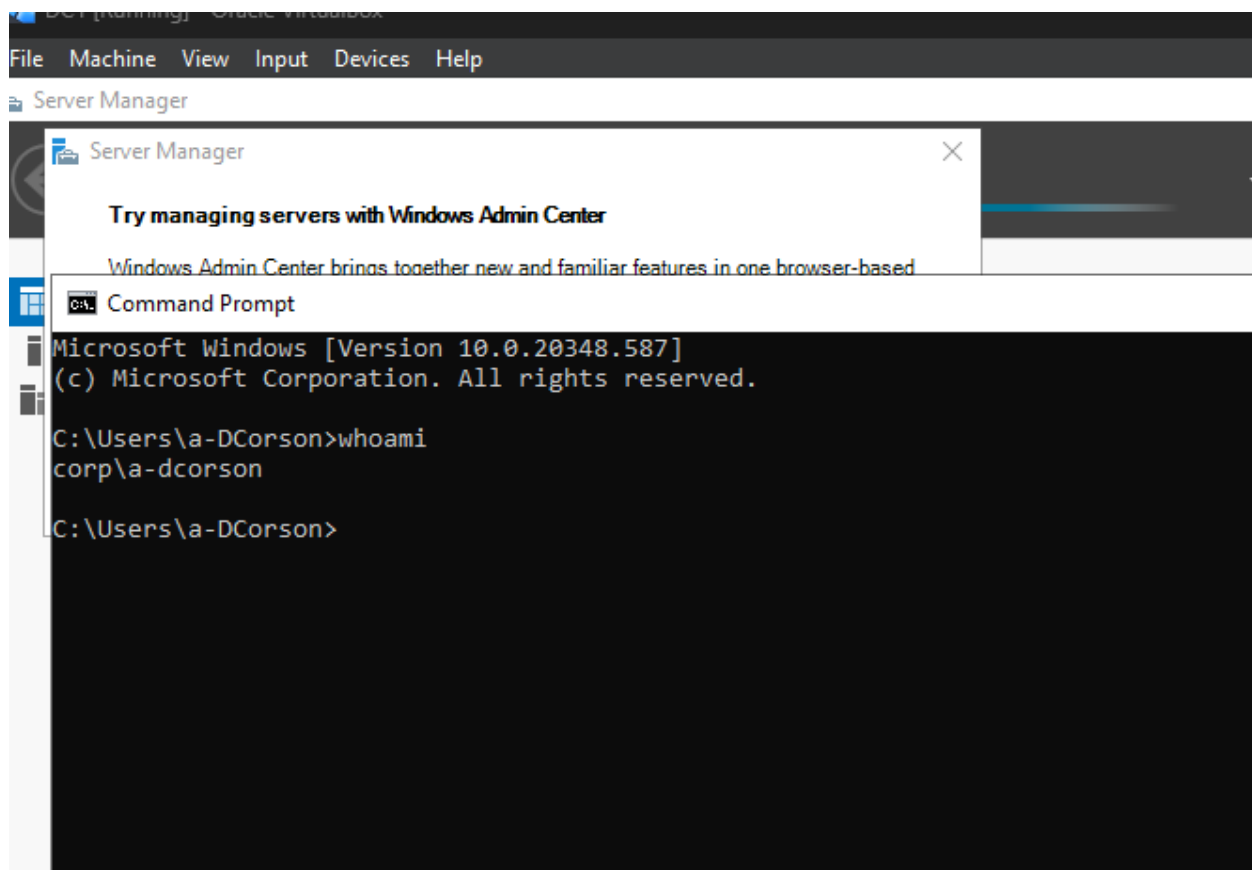


Figure 5. Verifying the active security context using the whoami command. The output confirms the session is authenticated as the dedicated Domain Administrator account within the CORP domain.

What Changed?

Prior to this phase, administrative tasks were performed using the built-in Administrator account created during Domain Controller promotion. After creating a dedicated Domain Administrator account and assigning it to the Domain Admins security group, future administrative tasks can be performed using an individually identifiable account. This approach aligns with enterprise security practices by improving accountability, supporting auditing, and reducing reliance on the default built-in Administrator account.